

ID: SOMA-M-P09

Title: Awareness of Body

Duration: 9m 59s (701 words)

Script Content:

[Practice]

When you're ready, let's begin this practice.

Today we explore the practice of being aware of our body. Our body is here with us through every moment of life. Often, we move through the day without noticing it, or we may notice it only when there is discomfort. This practice is an invitation to slow down and meet the body with awareness, curiosity, and care.

During the practice, your body may feel restless or calm, light or heavy, tense or relaxed. Explore meeting your body as it is, without changing the experience. Your mind's attention may wander, and that is normal. If that happens, gently bring your attention back to the body.

Now, begin by finding a posture that works for you, whether sitting or lying down, or even standing. You may choose to close your eyes, or soften and lower your gaze. Start by noticing how your body is being supported. Feel the chair, floor, or surface beneath you. Notice where there is weight, where there is pressure, where there is softness.

[Short Pause] (10s - Grounding)

Bring attention to the feet. Notice the contact they are making with the floor or the surface. There may be sensations of warmth, coolness, tingling. Perhaps there is little or no sensation at all. Notice the toes, heels, and soles. You might feel subtle differences between the left and right foot. Whatever is present for you is acceptable.

[Long Pause] (20s - Feet awareness)

When you feel ready, gently move your attention to the legs. Notice any sensations at the calves, the knees, the thighs. You might also notice how the legs feel in relation to the feet – perhaps connected, grounded, or supported. Allow any sensations of pressure or contact to be acknowledged.

[Long Pause] (20s - Leg awareness)

Now, bring your awareness to the torso – the belly, chest, and back. Notice the rise and fall of the chest and belly with each breath. There is no need to control the breath; simply allow it to come and go at its own natural rhythm.

You may notice warmth or coolness, tightness or ease, heaviness or lightness. The back may feel the support of the chair or floor. Each sensation is part of the present experience, and all are allowed to be here. If your body is asking for movement, adjust your posture gently, with awareness.

[Long Pause] (20s - Torso and Breath awareness)

Gently bring attention to the arms. Notice their position – resting on the lap, by your sides, or perhaps touching a surface. Sense the weight of the arms, the temperature of the skin, and any sensations in the hands, wrists, and fingers. You might notice how the arms feel when

relaxed, or if there is tension that could soften. Observe the space between the arms and torso, and allow your arms to rest comfortably without judgment.

[Long Pause] (20s - Arm and Hand awareness)

Now, expand your awareness to the head, face, and neck. Notice sensations in the scalp, forehead, jaw, cheeks, and around the eyes. Perhaps there is tension, warmth, or lightness. Notice the tongue and mouth, the sensation of breathing through the nose or mouth, and how the neck supports the head. Invite curiosity to any expression your face may have – relaxed, tense, or neutral – and allow it to be as it is.

[Long Pause] (20s - Head and Face awareness)

Now, expanding your awareness to the whole body. Notice how some parts may have more sensations, while some have fewer. Some areas may feel more comfortable, and others less so. Some parts may call more strongly for attention, while others reside in the background. Welcome any sensation to be a part of your experience.

[Long Pause] (20s - Whole body awareness)

If thoughts, memories, or emotions arise, notice how they may appear as sensations in part of the body. Perhaps tension in the shoulders is connected to a thought, or warmth in the chest is tied to a feeling. Welcome these connections without judgment. Your body and mind can be noticed together, allowing for understanding and gentleness.

Spend a few more moments resting with the body as a whole. There is no need to reach a special state or experience specific feelings.

[Pause] (20s - Final integration)

When you are ready, feel the support beneath the body once more. If you like, gently wiggle the toes and fingers. Take a slow, steady breath, and allow this practice to come to a close in your own time.

Thank you for your practice.

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